

Plan Feature Catalog

The subscription system now centralises feature metadata in `backend/src/modules/plans/planFeatureMetadata.js` . Each plan feature key is mapped to:

- the platform module it controls (ads, community, classes, tutorials, etc.)
- human friendly labels and descriptions used on the public pricing page
- parsing/formatting logic so booleans, counts, durations, and percentages are rendered consistently
- synthetic features derived from plan columns (`max_courses` , `ad_credits`) so instructor limits appear alongside database-driven feature flags

The catalog powers:

1. Automatic formatting of `/plans` responses — plan cards include labelled features with marketing copy instead of raw values.
2. Admin defaults — when an admin omits a feature description, the metadata file supplies one based on the value.
3. Seed data — default plans reuse the same metadata so website copy and runtime behaviour stay aligned.

Feature matrix

Module	Feature key	Description template
Commerce	<code>commission_rate</code>	Platform keeps {value} of each sale
Community	<code>groups_create</code>	Create and manage groups / Join groups as a member only
Community	<code>groups_join_limit</code>	Join up to {count} groups OR Join unlimited groups
Community	<code>community_post</code>	Post and reply in discussions / Read-only community access
Classes	<code>classes_create</code>	Publish online classes / Enroll only (no class publishing)
Tutorials	<code>tutorials_create</code>	Create tutorials with chapters / View tutorials only
Tutorials	<code>tutorials_max_count</code>	Publish up to {count} tutorials OR Unlimited published tutorials
Library	<code>books_download</code>	Download purchased books / Read-only access to library
Ads	<code>ads_max_ads</code>	Run up to {count} active ads OR Run unlimited active ads
Ads	<code>ads_max_duration</code>	Run ads up to {count} days OR No ad duration limit
Ads	<code>ads_allow_branding</code>	Use custom branding in ads / Platform branding only
Ads	<code>ads_show_analytics</code>	Access detailed ad analytics / No analytics dashboard
Classes (synthetic)	<code>max_courses</code>	Publish up to X active classes OR Publish unlimited active classes
Ads (synthetic)	<code>ad_credits</code>	{X} ad credits per billing cycle OR No ad credits included

All templates live alongside the feature definitions so any new feature only requires editing `planFeatureMetadata.js` (plus seed values where applicable).

Adding a new plan feature

1. Append the feature definition to `FEATURE_METADATA` with its module, labels, and any custom formatting rules.
2. Update `MODULE_ORDER` if the feature belongs to a new module category.

3. Seed the new feature in `backend/src/seeds/09_plans_seed.js` so baseline plans include sensible defaults.
4. (Optional) Add a synthetic feature entry in `SYNTHETIC_PLAN_FEATURES` if the value comes from a plan column instead of `plan_features`.

Because the formatter normalises booleans, numeric limits, durations, and percentages, the public pricing page automatically reflects the descriptive copy without additional frontend changes.